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Digital

Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

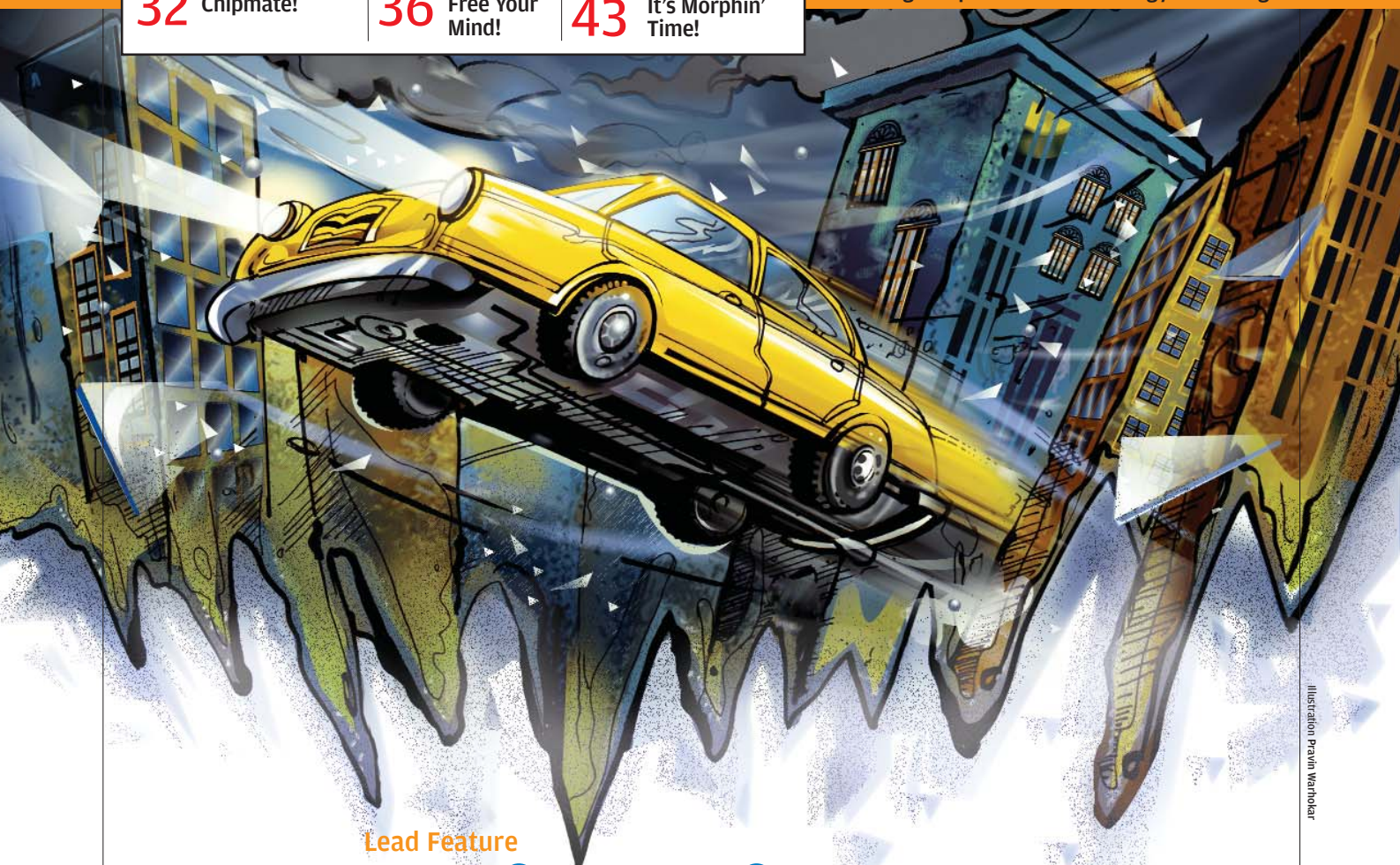


Illustration: Pravin Warthekar

Lead Feature

Still Life

A rainy day and wannabe Wachowski-ism; here's how you can make your own Matrix clone at home

Nimish Chandiramani

Ever since that first scene where Trinity paused in mid-air while contemplating serious damage to that poor cop, we've all been fascinated with the fabled "bullet time." Movie makers and game developers alike have used this technique to death, and then some. We can't beat them though, so we might as well join them. Stranded on a rainy day, we wondered: can one create one's own ultra-low budget (read nearly free) bullet time video to pass the day? As it turns out, one can—in a single day, and in the comfort of one's own home, too!

The Ingredients

Before we get started, we need to take inventory. You will need:

- ❑ At least six friends with digital cameras capable of recording video (if you have many cameras, the friends are optional). Mobile phone cameras will do too, but don't expect too much quality in the final product.
- ❑ An idea for your movie (ours, for example, films a radio-controlled car falling off a table and freezes the fall in between)
- ❑ VirtualDub (Get it off the May 2006 *Digit* CD or download it from www.virtualdub.org)
- ❑ Windows Movie Maker (Masochistic, aren't we)

The first thing you need to do before you start shooting is to make a storyboard. Using paper and pencil, draw a rough sketch of the various scenes in the movie. This will help you better understand the final output, not to mention help you plan the way you will shoot.